ITSM Process Framework

IT Service Management Reference Guide based on ITIL Practices

1. Introduction to ITSM

IT Service Management (ITSM) refers to the entirety of activities—directed by policies, organized and structured in processes and supporting procedures—that are performed by an organization to design, plan, deliver, operate and control information technology (IT) services offered to customers.

2. Core ITSM Lifecycles & Processes

2.1 Incident Management

Objective: To restore normal service operation as quickly as possible and minimize the adverse impact on business operations.

- **Identification & Logging:** Capturing details via self-service, monitoring alerts, or service desk calls.
- **Categorization & Prioritization:** Assigning correct impact and urgency matrix levels.
- **Investigation & Diagnosis:** Troubleshooting steps to pinpoint the immediate breakdown.
- **Resolution & Closure:** Applying workarounds or permanent hotfixes and confirming with the user.

2.2 Problem Management

Objective: To prevent incidents from happening and to minimize the impact of incidents that cannot be prevented.

- **Problem Detection:** Finding trends in recurring individual incidents.
- **Root Cause Analysis (RCA):** Determining the fundamental structural failure (e.g., faulty hardware, bug code).
- **Known Error Record:** Documenting workarounds in a shared Knowledge Base.

2.3 Change Enablement (Change Management)

Objective: To maximize the number of successful service and product changes by ensuring that risks have been properly assessed.

- **Standard Changes:** Low-risk, pre-authorized procedural alterations (e.g., password resets).
- **Normal Changes:** Requires rigorous scheduling, evaluation, and Change Advisory Board (CAB) validation.
- **Emergency Changes:** Rushed tracks implemented immediately to resolve a critical active outage.

2.4 Asset & Configuration Management (SACM)

Objective: To ensure that the assets required to deliver services are properly controlled, and that accurate information about configuration items (CIs) is available.

3. ITSM Process Matrix

PROCESS	FOCUS AREA	KEY METRIC (KPI)	PRIMARY USER TARGET
Incident Mgmt	Unplanned interruptions	Mean Time to Restore (MTTR)	End-Users / Service Desk
Problem Mgmt	Underlying root causes	Reduction in recurring incidents	Tier 3 Engineers / Ops
Change Mgmt	Risk-managed deployments	Change success rate (%)	CAB / Dev & SysAdmins
Request Fulfilment	Standard service requests	Request turnaround time	End-Users / IT Staff

4. Continuous Service Improvement (CSI)

Every ITSM framework must adopt a circular feedback mechanism. Performance metrics should be evaluated against Service Level Agreements (SLAs) regularly to optimize standard operating

procedures, eliminate hardware bottlenecks, and streamline infrastructure modifications over time.